

83.2 "WHOSE"

"Whose" is the relative word used to show possession or belonging.

This is the lawyer **whose** client lied in court.

[This lawyer's client lied in court.]



FURTHER EXAMPLES

The UK is an example of a country **whose** traffic laws are very strict.



Smith & Smith, **whose** success rate is very high, is a respected law firm.



83.3 "WHAT"

"What" is the relative word used to mean "the thing which" or "the things which."

This house is just **what** we were looking for.

[This house is the thing which we were looking for.]



FURTHER EXAMPLES

I don't know **what** it is, but I'm excited to open it!



These paintings are **what** I've been spending all my time on.



⚠ COMMON MISTAKES WORD ORDER WITH RELATIVE STRUCTURES

If a relative structure uses a question word such as "where" or "what," the word order in the clause following this word should be left as normal and should not be formed like a question.

This is just **what we were** looking for. ✓

This is correct.

This is just **what were we** looking for. ✗

Do not invert the subject and verb.